

Realme 12+ 5G

Buy it for the design and camera

Just over a month ago, Realme launched its first 2024 in the mid-range smartphone market with its Realme 12 Pro series. Now, the company is back with its latest budget offering: the Realme 12 series, comprising the Realme 12 5G and the subject of our scrutiny, the Realme 12+ 5G. The Realme 12+ 5G aims to make its mark in a crowded market, boasting a sleek design and an impressive camera setup. With its stylish vegan leather back panel and a robust 50 MP Sony LYT-600 sensor, this device promises both style and substance. However, it faces stiff competition from brands like POCO, Nothing, and iQOO. Can the Realme 12+ 5G distinguish itself amidst such rivals? And does it live up to its promise? Let's find out!

BUILD AND DESIGN

Like the Realme 12 Pro series, the company has collaborated with French luxury watchmaker Ollivier Savéo to design the new Realme 12+ 5G. The circular camera module is modelled after the dials of luxury watches, giving it a very unique and premium look. The back features a soft vegan leather finish with a silver strip running down the centre.

The Realme 12+ 5G is available in two colours – Pioneer Green and Navigator Beige. I got the former for review, and it looks stunning. In fact, I prefer this colour over the other; it is very unique and distinctive.

The frame of the phone is not my favourite though. It is a glossy plastic frame that looks a bit cheap and attracts a LOT of fingerprints. A matte texture would be infinitely better here. The phone is quite slim though, at just 7.87 mm and it weighs only 190 g. It is one of the slimmest phones in the market



at this price, which is pretty nice. It also comes with IP54 dust and water resistance, which is fairly common now.

The rear panel is nice and grippy but the phone's flat sides can dig into the palm of your hand over time and make it uncomfortable to hold. Also, the vibration motor feels really cheap; the feedback is very poor. Nevertheless, the back panel alone is a work of art; a true rarity at this competitive price.

DISPLAY

The Realme 12+ 5G houses a 6.67-inch AMOLED display with the usual niceties. You get Full HD+ resolution, 100% DCI-P3 colour gamut coverage, and 16.7 million colours support. There's also 120 Hz refresh rate support and HDR10+ support. Sadly though, HDR support is not available on Netflix yet and HDR videos on YouTube lag quite a bit. I hope Realme can fix this via a software update, mainly because the screen is quite bright and vivid already, so HDR content would look great on this.

Realme has also added a Rainwater Smart Touch feature where the phone's touch response is unhindered even if the screen is wet. This worked quite well during my testing and it is a useful feature to have, especially in cities like Mumbai where it rains a lot.

The Realme 12+ 5G is rated to have a peak brightness of 2,000 nits but in my testing, I got a maximum peak brightness reading of 1,022 nits under bright sunlight. This is pretty good for the price and I never faced any screen legibility issues. Content also looks rich and detailed on this phone, however, the POCO X6 does show it up with its 1.5K resolution display. Overall though, a solid AMOLED panel with impressive brightness and good colour reproduction; it is primarily let down by the HDR support issue.

PERFORMANCE

The Realme 12+ 5G houses the MediaTek Dimensity 7050 processor with the Mali-G68 MC4 GPU. It comes with 8 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and 128 or 256 GB of UFS 3.1 storage. Credit where its due, I'm glad Realme went with UFS 3.1 instead of 2.2 since the app loading and data transfer speeds are much faster compared to the costlier Nothing Phone (2a). That aside, this chipset is definitely not the fastest on the block.

For instance, in AnTuTu v10, the phone scores 6,06,667 which pales in comparison to the scores on the Nothing Phone (2a), and the POCO X6 5G. The phone scores 961 in Geek-Bench's Single Core test and 2,415 in the Multi Core test; again not the best at this budget. Then again, it does score well in PCMark Work, meaning it is pretty capable at running excel sheets, image editing, and general day to day tasks.

In GPU tests, the Realme 12+ scores 2278 points in 3D Mark Wild Life, a decent score that's sadly bested by the POCO X6 again. The same story repeats itself in GFXBench tests. Although the Realme 12+ 5G is not the most powerful phone at this price range, it is still smooth enough for